

Lender User Manual

Run your lending business — clients, loans, repayments & reports.

LenderFest ▪ Lender Guide ▪ Generated 05/06/2026

A step-by-step guide for **lenders** (microfinance institutions, SACCOs, chamas, and individual lenders) using LenderFest to run their lending business.

What is LenderFest? A cloud loan-management system. You manage clients, loans, repayments, capital, staff, and reports from one dashboard — and your borrowers get their own self-service portal.

1. Getting started

Create your account (free trial)

1. Go to the LenderFest home page and click **Start Free Trial**.

2. Fill in:

- **Business name** (e.g. *Faulu Microfinance*) - **Business type** — Microfinance, SACCO, Chama, or Individual Lender - **Your subdomain** (e.g. *faulu* □ your space at faulu.lenderfest.loans) - **Admin first & last name, email, password**

1. Click **Create account**. Your 14-day free trial starts immediately — no card needed.

Pricing after the trial: you pay **5% of the interest you actually earn** each month. No setup fee, no monthly minimum. Quiet month = no charge.

Log in

- Staff sign in at `/login` with their **email + password**.
- Forgot your password? Use the reset link on the login page.

Onboarding wizard (first login)

A short setup wizard walks you through:

1. **Business profile** — logo, contact details.

2. **Loan settings** — default interest rate, duration, min/max amounts.
3. **Capital pool** — how much money you have available to lend.
4. **First client** and **first loan** (optional — you can skip and do this later).
5. **Invite your team** (optional).

You can change any of these later in **Settings**.

2. The Dashboard

Your home screen shows:

- **Capital Pool** — available capital, total disbursed, collected, interest earned, and utilization. Admins can **Top up capital** here.
 - **KPI cards** — active loans, collections, outstanding, collection rate.
 - **Charts** — disbursed vs collected trend, and a portfolio-health donut by loan status.
 - **Recent loans & payments**.
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3. Managing clients

Add a client

Clients ▢ **Add Client**, then enter:

- First & last name, phone number, ID number (required: name + phone)
- Email, **Business name**, **Business type**
- **County**, Town/City, Address
- Date of birth, Gender

Every client you add automatically gets a **borrower portal login** so they can self-serve. Their default password is:

First-initial (capital) + last-initial (lowercase) + ID number + `@<year>` e.g. *John Doe*, ID **12345678**
▢ **Jd12345678@2026**

Share this with the client; they change it on first login.

Client profile

Click any client to see their **credit score**, all loans, payment history, **identity documents** (photo + ID front/back they uploaded in the portal), and options to **Edit**, **Download statement**, **Send SMS**, or **Email statement**.

4. Loans — the full lifecycle

A loan moves through these stages:

Status	Meaning
Pending	Application submitted, not yet reviewed
Under review	A staff member is reviewing it
Approved	Approved, awaiting disbursement (money not yet paid out)
Counter-offered	You offered a smaller amount; awaiting the client's response
Rejected	Declined
Active	Disbursed — money paid out, repayments running
Completed	Fully repaid
Defaulted	Overdue / not repaid

Important: a loan only appears in the borrower's **My Loans** once it is **disbursed (Active)**. Before that it stays in their **My Applications**.

Create a loan for a client

Loans ▢ **New Application:** pick the client, enter principal (within your min/max), duration, interest rate, and purpose. Add guarantor/collateral if needed.

Review & decide (Applications)

The **Applications** queue holds everything awaiting a decision — including loans your borrowers submitted online. For each one you can:

- **Start review** ▢ moves it to **Under review**.
- **Approve** (after review) ▢ **Approved**, ready to disburse.
- **Reject** ▢ with a reason.
- **Counter-offer** ▢ propose a **smaller principal**; the client accepts or declines from their portal. If they accept, it becomes **Approved** (awaiting your disbursement). If they decline, it's **Rejected**.

Disburse

Once **Approved**, **disburse** the loan (record method e.g. M-Pesa/cash). This:

- sets the loan **Active**,
- generates the repayment **schedule**,
- reduces your **available capital pool**, and

- makes the loan visible in the borrower's **My Loans**.

5. Payments & overdue

- **Record a payment** against a loan (M-Pesa, cash, bank). The schedule updates, a receipt/transaction is created, and your **collected** total + capital pool update.
- **Overdue** shows loans/instalments past due so you can follow up (and send SMS reminders).
- Each payment produces a **receipt** you can print or share.

6. Capital pool

Your capital pool tracks the money you lend:

- **Available capital** = initial capital – disbursed + collected.
- **Top up capital** (admins) when you add funds.
- **Utilization** shows how much of your capital is currently out on loan.

Disbursing a loan lowers available capital; collecting repayments raises it.

7. Reports & analytics

- **Analytics / Reports** — portfolio KPIs, Portfolio-at-Risk (PAR), aging, collections and disbursement trends.
- **Export** any report to **PDF** or **Excel**.
- **Exports** page — bulk export clients, loans, payments.

8. Staff & permissions

User Management (admin only) — add staff and assign a role:

Role	Can do
Admin	Everything, incl. settings, capital, users
Manager	Day-to-day operations, approvals
Loan Officer	Clients, loans, payments
Viewer	Read-only

Every action is recorded in the **Audit Log** (who did what, and when).

9. Communications

- **SMS and Email** — send statements, reminders, and bulk messages (once your SMS/email provider is configured by the platform).
- Automatic notifications for approvals, payments, and overdue alerts.

10. Branding & embedding

- **White-label settings** — your logo, brand color, and sender details so the borrower portal feels like *your* brand.
- **Embed** — drop a **loan calculator widget** on your own website; visitors can calculate and start an application that lands in your queue.

11. The borrower portal (what your clients see)

Your borrowers get a single LenderFest account that works across every lender they borrow from. They can:

- browse lenders, **link to you**, and apply online,
- track applications and respond to your counter-offers,
- view active loans, schedules, balances, and make payments,
- download statements and see their credit score.

(See the **Borrower User Manual** for their side.)

12. Quick troubleshooting

Issue	What to check
A client can't log in to the portal	Phone must be saved in +254.../07... form; share the default password (Section 3) or reset it
Loan not showing in client's *My Loans*	It must be Disbursed (Active) — approved loans stay in *My Applications*
Can't disburse	The loan must be Approved first, and you need enough available capital
Capital pool looks wrong	It updates on disburse/collect; top up if low

SMS/Email not sending	The provider must be enabled for your account
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Need help? Contact LenderFest support from the footer of the site.

